

there would be a preponderance of souls that could not be classified as *ašavan* or as *dragvant*? Souls in this limbo only suffered the changes of temperature due to the seasons, and the Regeneration would bring their dubious position to an end. Later speculations of this nature need not be described; but one specimen might be noted, the case of Keresâspa. This hero might have been expected to go to *Garōnmāna* for his exploits in dragon-slaying, related in *Yt* 19³⁸ ff. and elsewhere. But he was unfortunate enough to offend the Fire, by attempting cookery on what seemed an island but was really a sea-monster's back. The monster withdrew into the depths, Âtar suffering extinction in the process; and "the manly-minded Keresâspa fled affrighted," though the Pahlavi commentator assures us that he proved his manly-mindedness by keeping his wits under obviously trying circumstances. It seems a little hard that he should be condemned to limbo for an act so unintentionally disrespectful to the majesty of Fire. The story is worth repeating for the patent contrast it affords to the lines of Zarathustra's thought. His "middling souls" were, we may be sure, determined on more ethical principles; but the scanty indications of the Gathas are not enough to satisfy our curiosity further. It is interesting to compare Plato's treatment of the same problem in the mythus of the *Phædo*, c. 62. Roth compares also a passage in the Koran (Sur. 7) where men of this kind abide on the ridge of the wall separating paradise and hell, content to escape the torments they see on the one side, but full of unquenchable longing for the joys visible on the